

TROD CONTROL

Military strategists know that controlling roads is an essential part of successful planning, and the fae exercise this practice inside the Dreaming to protect both worlds from the Elder Dark, in addition to preventing coups and local opponents from gaining access to their domains. By populating areas within the Dreaming alongside (and at the end of) trods, the Kithain ensure trod control while also providing their crafters the opportunity to use workshops that are empowered merely by existing in the chimerical world. In the wake of attacks by dark fae and monstrous chimera after the Evanescence, both the Seelie and Unseelie Courts impress upon their members the crucial importance of securing trods.

Opening Gateways

Trod access means locating, or creating, a gateway between worlds. Kithain with a deep affinity to the Dreaming, such as the eshu and the Arcadian sidhe, receive an additional die on such rolls.

Wayfare

Through combining Portal Passage (Wayfare ☉☉☉) and the Fae Realm (Dweomer of Glamour, ☉☉☉☉☉), it's possible to create temporary portals onto a random trod in the Near Dreaming. However, players may opt to cast this cantrip as an extended action, requiring five successes, to assign a basic trod type (Silver Path, Path of Balor, or Twilight Road).

Unleashing Wayfare

Creating temporary rifts between the worlds via Unleashing requires the Art-wielder to command the Dreaming to manifest them. In addition to basic repercussions from botching an Unleashing, such powerful magical mishaps create at least one Wild Portal somewhere in the caster's general surroundings.

Coaxing the Dreaming requires the use of an established gateway as focal point for the Unleashing. This allows the bypassing of any appeasement requirements that the pathways have but the caster doesn't know or can't fulfill. Botching this roll results in changing the destination permanently, destroying the gateway, or even opening a portal into a prison realm, causing the return of additional Thallain or Dark-kin.

Oneiromancy

Sleeping minds connect to the Dreaming unconsciously, allowing all but the most Banality-ridden mortal a brief glimpse into a lost world. Dream Portal (Oneiromancy ☉☉☉) provides all the tools needed to anchor a mind inside the Dreaming. Kithain who have mastered the Fae Realm can merely opt to sidestep their journey through the Dreaming onto a random trod, with any fellow travelers (through use of the Scene realm) automatically joining them. Pulling a mortal into the Dreaming requires the use of the appropriate Actor level, but regardless of travelers, the process never brings physical bodies to the other side (unless in Wyrd before being the target of the spell).

Mortal minds return to their bodies after eight hours of sleep, during which it's impossible to wake them in the Autumn world. Death inside the Dreaming causes the physical body to suffer severe brain damage, or puts the mortal in a coma from which she may never emerge.

Due to the connection with the Dreaming, chimerical souls manifest as if they entered through physical gateways. Those with a chimerical nature aren't limited to staying for a certain amount of hours, instead they must leave through a gateway or have someone use a Dream Portal cantrip or Unleash Oneiromancy. If the physical body dies while the Kithain remains in the Dreaming, she automatically becomes lost, unable to return to the Autumn world. Treat dying changelings according to the chimerical death rules on p. 291 since their mortal bodies remain in the Autumn world.

Unleashing Oneiromancy

When commanding the Art, the barrier between the target's mind and the Dreaming grows weak. If awake, the target immediately falls asleep, thus making it possible for the caster to Unleash on herself. A botch on the roll thins the veil between planes and gives the location a nightmarish aura, which attracts nightmare chimera seeking release into the mundane world.

Coaxing requires the caster to already be inside the Dreaming. It creates temporary trods that lead to specific dreamers' minds where the changeling can command an Unleashing or use Dream Portal to exit. Botching the roll creates a trod that connects to a dangerous location in the Dreaming, or the sleeping mind of a dangerous fae (a Thallain, perhaps, or even a Dauntain) with control over her own dream realm. It also creates a hidden Wild Portal — detectable with Perception + Kenning (difficulty 9) — somewhere close to the caster's physical form in the Autumn Realm.

Established Gateways

An established gateway remains connected to the same trod regardless of how many times it's used. Every functioning freehold has at least one, which leads into the Near Dreaming, and it's not uncommon for such gateways to exist in Glamour-rich environments. All of the gateways share one trait: They require certain conditions to open. Some open after hearing a poem or being tapped rhythmically, others require solving complex riddles or only open at a specific time of the year.

In general, the deeper into the Dreaming a trod takes its wayfarers, the more complex and esoteric its conditions. Near Dreaming gateways tend to only need simple tasks such as tapping the surface of the portal a particular number of times, solving easy riddles, or playing a specific song on an instrument from start to finish. Portals with trods to the Far Dreaming only open at specific times of the day, require an entrant to solve difficult or abstract enigmas, answer philosophical dilemmas that appear in writing briefly on the surface, or even the sacrifice of a Treasure (up to ☉☉). Deep Dreaming gates takes this a step further by only opening on a specific date, requiring blood or sentient chimera sacrifices, or a series of complex tasks to be presented during the opening.